

Pant and Jurel, opposites that could complete each other

Rishabh Pant bats like a maverick but keeps classically. Dhruv Jurel's the reverse, a modern keeper with a traditional batting technique. **Can India's Test balance accommodate both?**

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Few dilemmas in sport are as welcome as a problem of plenty. The Indian Test team now faces that very problem, with two world-class wicketkeepers in its ranks: Rishabh Pant and Dhruv Jurel. **Pant's credentials as one of the finest wicketkeeper-batters in the world are beyond dispute, while Jurel has emerged as a more-than-capable understudy.**

After a series of impressive performances, including a maiden Test hundred against West Indies, Jurel has



Since his debut in 2018, only Virat Kohli has scored more Test runs for India than Rishabh Pant (3427). The 28-year-old also has eight hundreds in the format, the most by an Indian wicketkeeper.

forced a fresh question: can India fit both these gifted keeper-batters into one Test XI?

Former India wicketkeeper and broadcaster Saba Karim believes it is possible, given Jurel's rising stature with the bat.

"Jurel's recent form strengthens his case, but team balance also depends on giving opportunities to specialist batters waiting on the bench. Going purely by form, it's not an impossible combination," said Karim.

India's recent home Test series against West Indies offered a glimpse of how both Pant and Jurel could feature together. The team selection told two contrasting stories: one of opportunity unfulfilled, and another of a youngster quietly cementing his place.

Nitish Kumar Reddy, billed as a batting all-rounder, was barely used with the ball and didn't get enough time with the bat. Across four innings against West Indies, he bowled four of India's 290 overs and